

ly, since these do not require cutting of trees for printing paper.

Some buying tips

Here are some pointers you need to keep in mind while buying an e-book reader:

Formats supported. Look at the different types of files and digital formats that the e-book reader supports. If there is a particular electronic file that you usually use, make sure that your e-book reader is able to read it. Nowadays audio books are also widely popular. If you are interested in these, check whether your e-book reader supports the format.

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Resources available. Books for e-readers are important to check before buying a reader. There are readers to which many online stores cannot sup-

Some advantages of tablets over e-book readers

1. Tablets do not have a restricted library that supports only the e-book library of the device. Books can be accessed from various stores and many a times at discounts that might not be available at a particular store.
2. Tablets have a coloured display. So reading text with pictures is more entertaining.
3. Since tablets have a backlit display, these allow reading even in dark.

ply books. This might restrict you from accessing several books of your choice.

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or directional pad), weight and the screen-refresh time.

e-book reader vs tablets

Many tablets available in the market support e-book reading. That means users can download e-books on their tablets for reading. The question arises: Why will a buyer go for an e-book reader when there are much cheaper and multi-utility options available in the market that perform the same function?

The foremost reason is that tablets do not use the E Ink technology and hence reading on a tablet is a different experience—more like watching a laptop or computer screen than going through a book. So if your primary focus is reading books, buy an e-book reader with an E Ink screen. A tablet is not made to be viewed in sunlight, and it might even overheat in direct sunlight. An e-book's display, on the other hand, appears like a paper book, which can be read in light. Also, the backlit screen of tablet is harder on the eyes for many.

Tablets are primarily not meant for reading. e-book reading is instead only one of the many applications that tablets offer. An e-book reader, on the other hand, is a dedicated device for reading books. A dedicated device, by definition, is largely used for a single purpose. So there will be no applications or e-mail and message alerts popping up on your screen as you read a book on an e-book reader. Also, as fewer applications will be draining its usable battery life, an e-book reader will have a battery life extending to a few days as against iPad's battery life of only about ten hours. ●

The author is an assistant editor at EY

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